

Ulla Marchetti

Chronicle, volume 1

Dreamy and forgetful fishmonger of the Frostwall garrison on the northern border

Volume 3 of 3 in the Ulla Marchetti collection. The other volumes cover the rest of this character's record.

About this volume

Day-to-day records kept by Ulla, fishmonger of the Frostwall garrison on the northern border, in no particular order of importance. Among the things Ulla keeps at the east rampart is a copper pipe; Ulla calls it 'Old Patience' and will not explain why. It appears in these pages more often than it deserves.

<i>Full name</i>	Ulla Marchetti
<i>Volume</i>	Chronicle 1
<i>Name of the copper pipe</i>	Old Patience

Entries

Entry 1, spring of year 13

The weather turned. Ulla moved the cracked compass indoors and wrote three lines to an old friend about the quarantine. Ulla closed early, walked to the frozen moat, and watched the lights come on. Ulla closed early, walked to the frozen moat, and watched the lights come on. Ulla won 43 iron pennies on a bet about the harvest count and spent all of it on supper. The weather turned. Ulla moved the iron kettle indoors and wrote three lines to an old friend about the tax on doors. Ulla polished 'Old Patience', the copper pipe, and said nothing about it.

Entry 2, autumn of year 13

Rumours about the tariff on salt reached the east rampart. Ulla pretended not to care and then asked everyone about it. Ulla repaired the tin whistle at the east rampart for Sixten, who paid in 25 iron pennies and a long story about the price of lamp oil. A stranger asked Ulla for the password to the workshop. Ulla laughed and said it was written on the wall, which it is not. At the east rampart, Ulla taught a newcomer how to tell a real grain scale from a fake one by weight alone. An old teacher visited unannounced. They argued about the quarantine for an hour and parted better friends than before.

Entry 3, spring of year 13

Rumours about the singing at the docks reached the signal tower. Ulla pretended not to care and then asked everyone about it. Ulla spent the day counting stock at the signal tower: 19 of everything, except the coil of rope, which is always short. Ulla found a coil of rope half-buried near the signal tower and spent the evening trying to work out who had lost it. A stranger asked Ulla for the password to the workshop. Ulla laughed and said it was written on the wall, which it is not.

Entry 4, spring of year 13

the Frostwall Legion sent a notice about the rumour of a second well. Ulla read it twice, folded it into a square and used it to level a table. Ulla was hired to carry a wax seal from the quartermaster's stores to the mess hall without opening it, and mostly succeeded. Ulla won 57 iron pennies on a bet about the tax on doors and spent all of it on supper.

Entry 5, spring of year 13

An old teacher visited unannounced. They argued about the quarantine for an hour and parted better friends than before. A dispute over the missing shipment flared up between Ulla and a neighbour outside the signal tower; it ended, as usual, with neither of them conceding. Ulla repaired the pair of spectacles at the signal tower for Astrid, who paid in 53 iron pennies and a long story about the census. Ulla repaired the signal flag at the signal tower for Ravi, who paid in 6 iron pennies and a long story about the harvest count. Cassius came by asking about the old tunnels. Ulla said nothing useful and made tea instead.

Entry 6, spring of year 13

A dispute over the old tunnels flared up between Ulla and a neighbour outside the quartermaster's stores; it ended, as usual, with neither of them conceding. Ulla closed early, walked to the east rampart, and watched the lights come on. Ulla spent the day counting stock at the quartermaster's stores: 11 of everything, except the iron kettle, which is always short. A stranger asked Ulla for the password to the workshop. Ulla laughed and said it was written on the wall, which it is not.

Entry 7, autumn of year 13

The weather turned. Ulla moved the oilskin map indoors and wrote three lines to an old friend about whether the bridge will hold. Ulla was hired to carry a ledger from the frozen moat to the signal tower without opening it, and mostly succeeded. Ulla won 52 iron pennies on a bet about the comet and spent all of it on supper. An old teacher visited unannounced. They argued about the missing shipment for an hour and parted better friends than before. A stranger asked Ulla for the password to the workshop. Ulla laughed and said it was written on the wall, which it is not.

Entry 8, winter of year 13

the Frostwall Legion sent a notice about the missing shipment. Ulla read it twice, folded it into a square and used it to level a table. Ulla spent the day counting stock at the mess hall: 84 of everything, except the ledger, which is always short. Ulla found a oilskin map half-buried near the mess hall and spent the evening trying to work out who had lost it.

Entry 9, autumn of year 14

Ulla repaired the clockwork bird at the frozen moat for Yusuf, who paid in 40 iron pennies and a long story about the missing shipment. Jasper came by asking about whether the bridge will hold. Ulla said nothing useful and made tea instead. An old teacher visited unannounced. They argued about whether the bridge will hold for an hour and parted better friends than before. Ulla spent the day counting stock at the frozen moat: 85 of everything, except the glass float, which is always short.

Entry 10, summer of year 14

Ulla repaired the cracked compass at the mess hall for Marisol, who paid in 40 iron pennies and a long story about the harvest count. An old teacher visited unannounced. They argued about the tariff on salt for an hour and parted better friends than before. At the mess hall, Ulla taught a newcomer how to tell a real glass float from a fake one by weight alone. Ulla found a spool of wire half-buried near the mess hall and spent the evening trying to work out who had lost it. Ulla won 66 iron pennies on a bet about the comet and spent all of it on supper.

Entry 11, spring of year 14

Someone left a ledger on the doorstep with no note. Ulla has a suspect and is probably right. the Frostwall Legion sent a notice about the missing shipment. Ulla read it twice, folded it into a square and used it to level a table. An old teacher visited unannounced. They argued about the tax on doors for an hour and parted better friends than before. A stranger asked Ulla for the password to the workshop. Ulla laughed and said it was written on the wall, which it is not.

Entry 12, summer of year 14

Ulla closed early, walked to the mess hall, and watched the lights come on. Ulla repaired the brass lantern at the east rampart for Tomasz, who paid in 58 iron pennies and a long story about the right way to mend a net. Teodora came by asking about the price of lamp oil. Ulla said nothing useful and made tea instead. the Frostwall Legion sent a notice about the harvest count. Ulla read it twice, folded it into a square and used it to level a table. A dispute over who really won the regatta flared up between Ulla and a neighbour outside the east rampart; it ended, as usual, with neither of them conceding.

Entry 13, autumn of year 14

A dispute over who really won the regatta flared up between Ulla and a neighbour outside the mess hall; it ended, as usual, with neither of them conceding. Ulla closed early, walked to the quartermaster's stores, and watched the lights come on. the Frostwall Legion sent a notice about the tariff on salt. Ulla read it twice, folded it into a square and used it to level a table.

Entry 14, summer of year 14

Ulla found a tin whistle half-buried near the frozen moat and spent the evening trying to work out who had lost it. Someone left a copper pipe on the doorstep with no note. Ulla has a suspect and is probably right. Ulla closed early, walked to the east rampart, and watched the lights come on.

Entry 15, summer of year 14

Ulla repaired the iron kettle at the frozen moat for Sixten, who paid in 55 iron pennies and a long story about who really won the regatta. A dispute over whether the bridge will hold flared up between Ulla and a neighbour outside the frozen moat; it ended, as usual, with neither of them conceding. A stranger asked Ulla for the password to the workshop. Ulla laughed and said it was written on the wall, which it is not. the Frostwall Legion sent a notice about who really won the regatta. Ulla read it twice, folded it into a square and used it to level a table. Ulla was hired to carry a brass lantern from the frozen moat to the signal tower without opening it, and mostly succeeded.

Entry 16, winter of year 14

Ulla was hired to carry a glass float from the mess hall to the east rampart without opening it, and mostly succeeded. Rumours about the quarantine reached the mess hall. Ulla pretended not to care and then asked everyone about it. the Frostwall Legion sent a notice about the price of lamp oil. Ulla read it twice, folded it into a square and used it to level a table.

Entry 17, winter of year 15

The weather turned. Ulla moved the glass float indoors and wrote three lines to an old friend about the harvest count. Ulla was hired to carry a hand bell from the east rampart to the frozen moat without opening it, and mostly succeeded. Ulla won 64 iron pennies on a bet about the tariff on salt and spent all of it on supper. An old teacher visited unannounced. They argued about the tariff on salt for an hour and parted better friends than before. the Frostwall Legion sent a notice about the census. Ulla read it twice, folded it into a square and used it to level a table.

Entry 18, summer of year 15

A stranger asked Ulla for the password to the workshop. Ulla laughed and said it was written on the wall, which it is not. Ulla was hired to carry a cracked compass from the mess hall to the signal tower without opening it, and mostly succeeded. Ulla found a sextant half-buried near the mess hall and spent the evening trying to work out who had lost it. An old teacher visited unannounced. They argued about the quarantine for an hour and parted better friends than before. Ulla spent the day counting stock at the mess hall: 15 of everything, except the bolt of linen, which is always short.

Entry 19, winter of year 15

At the east rampart, Ulla taught a newcomer how to tell a real grain scale from a fake one by weight alone. The weather turned. Ulla moved the spool of wire indoors and wrote three lines to an old friend about the harvest count. Percival came by asking about the tax on doors. Ulla said nothing useful and made tea instead. Rumours about the missing shipment reached the east rampart. Ulla pretended not to care and then asked everyone about it.

Entry 20, autumn of year 15

Juniper came by asking about the comet. Ulla said nothing useful and made tea instead. Ulla found a ledger half-buried near the frozen moat and spent the evening trying to work out who had lost it. An old teacher visited unannounced. They argued about the comet for an hour and parted better friends than before. At the frozen moat, Ulla taught a newcomer how to tell a real grain scale from a fake one by weight alone.